J. Hunter Priniski, PhD

Cognitive scientist and AI researcher developing experimental, computational, and theoretical methods for improving human agency in networked society.

Contact
email: priniski@ucla.edu
substack: @NewSage

Websites
Research Portfolio
Google Scholar
Citations: 366; H-index: 11

Current

Postdoctoral Fellow, Department of Psychology, UCLA, August 2024 - current

Advisory

PublicScholarship.org, Arizona State University
Suffering Beliefs Project, Duke University

Education

PhD, Computational Cognition, 2024
University of California, Los Angeles, CA
Dissertation: Belief dynamics in online social networks (*Kate Gordon Moore Award*)
Advisor: Keith Holyoak

BS, Mathematics, 2017, *summa cum laude*
Barrett, The Honors College
Arizona State University, Tempe, AZ

Publications

Priniski, J.H. (2026). How AI Shapes Human Narratives. *Journal of Language and Social Psychology.* Special Issue: How AI changes human communication.

Priniski, J. H., Linford, B., Krishna, S., Morstatter, F., Brantingham, J., & Lu, H. (2026). Network structure shapes consensus dynamics through individual decisions. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*, *123*(2), e2520483123.

Jha, A., **Priniski, J. H.**, Stienle, C., Morstatter, F. (2025). Simulating hashtag dynamics with networks of generative agents. In International Conference on Advances in Social Networks Analysis and Mining (pp. 151-165). Cham: Springer Nature Switzerland. *Best Paper Runner Up.*

Priniski, J. H., Linford, B., Morstatter, F., Brantingham, J., & Lu, H. (2025). Effect-prompting shifts causal relations expressed during online communication. In Proceedings of the 47th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society.

Priniski, J. H., Linford, B., Krishna, S., Morstatter, F., Brantingham, J., & Lu, H. (2024). Online network topology shapes personal narratives and hashtag generation. In Proceedings of the 46th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society.

Linford, B., **Priniski, J. H.**, & Lu, H. (2024). Social Sampling in Decision Making for Online and Offline Activities. In Proceedings of the 46th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society.

Priniski, J.H., Verma, I., & Morstatter, F. (2023). Pipeline for modeling causal beliefs from natural language. In Proceedings of the 61st Annual Meeting of the Association for Computational Linguistics (Volume 3: System Demonstrations) (pp. 436-443).

Priniski, J. H., & Holyoak, K.J. (2022). A Darkening Spring: How Preexisting

Distrust Shaped COVID-19 Skepticism. *PLOS One 17*(1).

Adams, C., Bozhidarova, M., Chen, J., Gao, A., Liu, Z., **Priniski, J.H.**, Lin, J., Sonthalia, R., Bertozzi, A. L. & Brantingham, P. J. (2022). Knowledge Graphs of the QAnon Twitter Network. Proceedings of the *2022 IEEE International Conference on Big Data.*

Harandizadeh, B., **Priniski, J.H**., Morstatter, F. (2022). Keyword Assisted Embedded Topic Modeling. *Proceedings of the 15th ACM International Conference on Web Search and Data Mining.*

Priniski, J.H., McClay, M., & Holyoak, K.J. (2021). Rise of QAnon: A Mental Model of Good and Evil Stews in an Echochamber. In T. Fitch, C. Lamm, H. Leder, & Te ßmar-Raible (Eds.) *Proceedings of the 43rd Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society.* Austin, TX: Cognitive Science Society.

Lee, J., **Priniski, J.H**., Valderrama, S., & Holyoak, K.J. (2021). Disgraced professionals: Revelation of immorality decreases evaluations of professional competence and accomplishment. In T. Fitch, C. Lamm, H. Leder, & Te ßmar-Raible (Eds.) *Proceedings of the 43rd Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society.* Austin, TX: Cognitive Science Society.

Priniski, J.H., Mokhberian, N., Harandizadeh, B., Morstatter, F., Lerman, K., Lu., H., Brantingham, J.B. (2021). Mapping Moral Valence of Tweets Following the Killing of George Floyd. In K. McKeown & T. Abdelzaher (Eds.), *Proceedings of the 6th International Workshop on Social Sensing.* AAAI. Menlo Park, CA: USA.

Priniski, J.H. & Holyoak, K.J. (2020). Crowdsourcing to Analyze Belief Systems Underlying Social Issues. In S. Denison, M. Mack, Y. Xu, & B.C. Armstrong (Eds.), *Proceedings of the 42nd Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society.* Austin, TX: Cognitive Science Society.

Priniski, J.H. & Horne, Z. (2019). Crowdsourcing effective educational interventions. In A.K. Goel, C. Seifert, & C. Freksa (Eds.), *Proceedings of the 41st Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society.* Austin, TX: Cognitive Science Society.

Priniski, J.H. & Horne, Z. (2018). Attitude Change on Reddit's Change My View. In T.T. Rogers, M. Rau, X. Zhu, & C. W. Kalish (Eds.), *Proceedings of the 40th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society* (pp. 2276-2281). Austin, TX: Cognitive Science Society.

Kwon, K.H., **Priniski, J.H.**, & Chanda, M. (2018). Disentangling User Samples: A Supervised Machine Learning Approach to Proxy-population Mismatch in Twitter Research. *Communication Methods and Measures*, *12*(2), 216-237.

Kwon, K.H., **Priniski, J. H.**, Sarkar, S., Shakarian, J. & Shakarian, P. (2017). Crisis and Collective Problem Solving in Dark Web: An Exploration of a Black Hat Forum. In A. Gruzd, J. Jacobson, & P. Mai (Eds.), *Proceedings of the 8th International Conference on Social Media & Society.* New York City, NY: Association for Computing Machinery.

Preprints

Priniski, J.H. & Pinillos, N.A. (2026). AI Narratives in Public Scholarship.

Priniski, J. H., Linford, B., Morstatter, F., Brantingham, P.J., & Lu, H. (2026). Narrative dynamics in experimentally controlled human-AI hybrid networks.

Priniski, J.H., Solanki, P., & Horne, Z. (2024). A computational framework for distinguishing motivated reasoning and practical rationality. PsyArXiv.

Presentations

Priniski, J.H. (2026, October) *How Emerging Technologies Rewire Human Narratives.* Cognitive Forum, Department of Psychology, UCLA, Los Angeles, CA.

Priniski, J.H. (2026, March) *How Narratives Take Shape.* Lectures on Tap, Boomtown Brewery, Los Angeles, CA.

Priniski, J.H. (2026, Feb) *Narrative dynamics in online social networks.* Annenberg School of Communication. University of Southern California, Los Angeles, California.

Priniski, J.H. (2025, November) *Storytelling in the 21st century.* Complex Systems Institute, University of Vermont, Burlington, Vermont.

Priniski, J.H. (2025, July) *Online political communication: How it works, and where we went wrong.* Symposium on cognitive science of political communication. Cognitive Science Society. San Francisco, California.

Priniski, J.H. (2025, Jan) *Running network experiments with oTree.* Annenberg School of Communication. University of Southern California, Los Angeles, California.

Priniski, J.H. (2024, Nov) *Conspiracies in the mind and world. Thinking* graduate seminar, Department of Psychology, UCLA, Los Angeles, California.

Priniski, J.H. (2024, Oct) *Cognitive complexity and network structure shape narrative interaction in online social networks.* Policy & Internet, University of Sydney, Australia.

Priniski, J.H. (2023, Oct) *Belief dynamics in a hashtag generation game.* Cognitive Forum, University of California, Los Angeles.

Priniski, J.H. (2023, March) *Conspiracy thinking in online social networks. Thinking* graduate seminar, Department of Psychology, UCLA, Los Angeles, California.

Priniski, J.H. (2022, July) *Modeling causal relations in natural language: why do it, why it's difficult, paths forward.* 1st Edinburgh Computational Cognitive Science Workshop, Univesrity of Edinburgh, Scotland.

*Horne, Z. & ***Priniski, J.H.** (2021, Dec) *Correcting misconceptions in the lab and wild.* DeepMind, London, U.K. (Remote).

Priniski, J.H (2021, July). *How Conspiracy Thinking Works.* International Conference on Social Computing, Behavioral-Cultural Modeling & Prediction and Behavior Representation in Modeling and Simulation (Remote).

Priniski, J.H.. (2021, June). *Mapping Moral Valence of Tweets Following the Killing of George Floyd.* 6th International Workshop on Social Sensing (Remote).

Priniski, J.H. (2021, January). *Guiding Intervention Development with Naturalistic Data.* Guest lecture in *Naturalistic data in psychology.* Department of Psychology and Language Sciences, University of Edinburgh, Scotland (Remote).

Priniski, J.H. (2020, July). *Crowdsourcing to Analyze Belief Systems Underlying*

Social Issues. 42nd Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society, Toronto, CA.

Posters

Priniski, J. H., Linford, B., Cao, D., Morstatter, F., Brantingham, J., & Lu, H. (2025). *Effect-prompting shifts causal relations expressed during networked interaction.* Proceedings of the 44th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, San Francisco, California.

Priniski, J. H., Linford, B., Krishna, S., Morstatter, F., Brantingham, J., & Lu, H. (2024). *Online network topology shapes personal narratives and hashtag generation.* Proceedings of the 43rd Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, Rotterdam, Netherlands.

Linford, B., **Priniski, J. H.**, & Lu, H. (2024). *Social Sampling in Decision Making for Online and Offline Activities.* Proceedings of the 43rd Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society, Rotterdam, Netherlands.

Priniski, J.H., McClay, M., & Holyoak, K.J. (2021, July). *Rise of QAnon: A Mental Model of Good and Evil Stews in an Echochamber.* Poster session presented at the 43rd Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society, Vienna, Austria (Remote).

Priniski, J.H. & Horne, Z. (2020, July). *Intuitive theories of persuasion shape engagement in discussion of polarizing issues.* Poster session presented at the 42nd Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society, Toronto, CA (Remote).

Priniski, J.H. & Horne, Z. (2019, July). *Crowdsourcing effective educational interventions.* Poster session presented at the 41st Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society, Montreal, CA.

Priniski, J.H. & Horne, Z. (2019, February). *Crowdsourcing Attitude Change from Reddit's Change My View.* Poster session presented at the Society for Personality and Social Psychology Intervention Science Preconference, Portland, OR.

Priniski, J.H. & Horne, Z. (2018, July). *Attitude Change on Reddit's Change My View.* Poster session presented at the 40th Annual Conference of the Cognitive Science Society, Madison, WI.

Awards

Best Paper (Runner Up), International Conference on Advances in Social Networks Analysis and Mining, 2025
Kate Gordon Moore Award, Best Cognitive Psychology Dissertation, UCLA, 2024
Dissertation Year Fellowship, UCLA, 2023 – 2024
Edwin W. Pauley Fellowship, UCLA, 2022 – 2023

Teaching

Teacher Assistant
Thinking (Graduate), Department of Psychology, UCLA, Winter 2023
Cognitive Psychology Laboratory, Department of Psychology, UCLA, Winter 2021
Signal Detection Theory – Psychophyiscal Theories and Methods, Fall 2020
Introduction to Psychology, Fall 2019

Professional Service

Journal Reviewer: PNAS Nexus, Cognitive Science, Journal of Experimental Psychology: General, PLOS ONE, and Policy & Internet.
Conference Reviewer: Cognitive Science Society (2018-2026)
Undergraduate Research Advising: Michelle Bak (PhD UIUC, Ast. Prof SUNY

Korea); Kedar Gupta (PhD student Columbia); Kaycee Stiemke (PhD student CMU); Caleb Mustfeldt (PhD student Princeton)

Education and Research

Coursework

ASU: Differential Equations, Linear Algebra, Real Analysis, Computational Methods, Mathematical Statistics, Probability Theory (*undergraduate*); Graph Theory, Game Theory, Linear Modeling (*graduate*)

UCLA: Computational cognitive modeling, probability theory, cognitive AI (*graduate*)

Computing Languages

Python (10 years, including HuggingFace, OpenAI, pytorch), R (8 years, including tidyverse, brms, rstan), MATLAB (6 years, including psychtoolbox)

Quantitative Methods

Agential AI, Machine Learning, Embedding-based methods, Bayesian data analysis, computational cognitive modeling, network science, relational data bases